TEXAS ROOTS Living MAGAZINE

NOVEMBER 2026 · GREATER HOUSTON

# The Season of Coming Home

*A full table, a guest-ready house, and what a 7% rate really costs.*

MARKET

Rates crossed 7%. Here is what that costs you.

HOME

A guest-ready house in one weekend

NEIGHBORHOOD

Kingwood, the Livable Forest

AT THE TABLE

Pumpkin dump cake, ten minutes of work



PETER & VICKY ROYSTER · THE MOVE LIVE LOVE TX TEAM™ · CB&A, REALTORS



# FROM OUR FRONT PORCH

*Neighbors. Trusted advisors. Friends.*

**Thank you for opening issue two.**

The first issue went out a month ago with a simple promise: real numbers, useful ideas for the home you're in, and something worth cooking. Issue two keeps it. If you made the chili, tell us how it went. We read every note.

November is the month for coming home, so that's what this issue is about. There's a weekend plan for getting the house ready for company, a pumpkin dump cake that takes ten minutes of actual work, and a walk through Kingwood, one of the most quietly beautiful places in our corner of Texas.

There's also the number everyone's asking us about. Rates crossed seven percent in September, and we put a real dollar figure on what that means, along with the parts of the payment you still control.

**From our table to yours, happy Thanksgiving.** We're grateful for every one of you.

GRATEFULLY,

*Peter & Vicky*

**PETER & VICKY ROYSTER**
REALTORS® · CB&A, Realtors · TREC #0520984 / #0737252

"Home isn't the house. It's who's at the table."

*— Peter*

*Let's keep in touch.*

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*We're building futures through real estate.*




**TEXAS ROOTS LIVING MAGAZINE**
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EXPLORE ONLINE ›

REAL NUMBERS. SMART MOVES.

# THE HOUSTON MARKET METER

A SNAPSHOT OF THE MARKET

The price held. The payment didn't. Mortgage rates crossed 7% in September and sales slowed.

THE MARKET IS
**BALANCED**
ROOM FOR BUYERS. EQUITY FOR SELLERS.



| MEDIAN SALE PRICE | AVERAGE SALE PRICE | HOMES SOLD |
|---|---|---|
| $325,000 | $421,311 | 7,030 |
| FLAT · FROM $325,990 | ↑ 0.7% YEAR OVER YEAR | ↓ 5.7% YEAR OVER YEAR |
| **ACTIVE LISTINGS** | **DAYS ON MARKET** | **MONTHS OF INVENTORY** |
| 40,192 | 58 | 5.5 |
| ↑ 6.3% YEAR OVER YEAR | ↑ from 56 LAST YEAR | ↑ from 5.1 · U.S. 4.8 |

Greater Houston single-family homes. Source: Houston Association of REALTORS® Housing Market Update, September 2026 data (released October 14, 2026). Information deemed reliable but not guaranteed.

## MARKET HIGHLIGHTS

### RATES CROSSED 7%
6.71% the first week of September, 7.03% the last.

### BUYERS ARE SLOWER TO COMMIT
6,789 homes went under contract, down 11.6%.

### CHOICE IS NEAR THE RECORD
40,192 listings, about 560 shy of July's high.

> Same house, same price, $83 more a month. That's September in one sentence.

Principal and interest on a median-priced home with 20% down, a year ago versus this September. The full math is on page 6.

*Let's talk strategy.*

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THE MARKET, UPDATED
**VIEW MARKET UPDATE ›**

THE MARKET, TRANSLATED

# WHAT THE NUMBERS MEAN FOR YOU

The price of a home held still in September. What it costs to own one did not. Here is what that changes about your November.

BY PETER ROYSTER

## MONTHS OF SUPPLY, AND WHAT EACH RANGE USUALLY MEANS




Inventory figure from HAR's September 2026 data. HAR treats four to six months of supply as a balanced market.

### IF YOU'RE BUYING

You have more to choose from, with listings close to July's record, and more time to choose. Homes averaged 58 days on the market in September, and 40,192 were for sale.

What you don't have is last year's payment. So run the payment first and fall in love second. A lender's quote at today's rate tells you your real price range; a list price doesn't.

If a townhome or condo fits your life, look hard right now. That corner of the market moved furthest toward buyers: sales fell 21.0%, the median dropped 9.1% to $209,000, and there are 9.3 months of supply.

### IF YOU'RE SELLING

Prices held, so your equity is still there. What thinned out is the line of buyers. Most of Houston sells between $150,000 and $500,000, and that is exactly where sales dropped: 8.4% from $150,000 to $249,999 and 5.7% from $250,000 to $499,999.

Price to what September's closed sales support, not to what your neighbor's house sold for in the spring. The buyer touring your house has already run their payment at 7%.

And budget for the wait. Fifty-eight days is the average now, and closing comes after that, so plan on at least two months of mortgage, taxes, and utilities.

*What we'd do in November*

If you're buying, get a full lender approval at today's rate before you tour, so you know the payment as well as the price. If you're selling, ask us for the closed sales in your own neighborhood and price range from the last ninety days. Those numbers, not the headlines, decide your list price.

*Where do you stand?*

A STRAIGHT READ ON YOUR OWN HOUSE

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NO OBLIGATION

GET YOUR HOME VALUE ›

THE LOAN CONVERSATION

# THE 7% QUESTION

*Mortgage rates crossed seven percent in September. Here is what the climb has cost so far, and what you still control.*

BY VICKY ROYSTER

## THE SAME HOUSE, A YEAR APART

| SEPTEMBER 2025 | SEPTEMBER 2026 | THE DIFFERENCE |
|---|---|---|
| 6.35% average rate | 6.86% average rate | +$83 |
| $1,622 | $1,705 | a month, or $997 a year |
| a month, principal and interest | a month, principal and interest | |

Median-priced Greater Houston single-family home ($325,000) with 20% down. Rates and payments from the Houston Association of REALTORS® Housing Market Update, September 2026 data. Taxes and insurance not included.

Every time rates move, our phone does too. The question is always some version of the same thing: should we wait? So let's put a number on what changed, because the number is smaller and more specific than the headlines make it sound.

The price of the typical Houston house didn't move this year. The median sale in September was $325,000, within a thousand dollars of last September. What moved was the rate. It averaged 6.35% a year ago and 6.86% this September, and it climbed all month, from 6.71% in the first week to 7.03% in the last. It kept going into October.

On that median house, with 20% down, the difference is $83 a month. That is real money. It is also a figure you can plan around, which is more than you can say for a guess about where rates go next.

Nobody can tell you that, including us. What we can tell you is which parts of the payment are still in your hands. There are more of them than most people think.

*Run your own numbers.*

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CONTINUED

OUR LENDER PARTNERS ›

# Waiting for rates to drop isn't a plan. It's a bet, and the house you want isn't waiting with you.

### 1 · THE PRICE IS STILL NEGOTIABLE

With 40,192 homes for sale and an average of 58 days on the market, sellers are listening. You can ask for more than a lower price. A seller can put money toward your closing costs or toward buying your rate down, within the limits your loan program allows. On some deals that does more for your monthly payment than a price cut of the same size. Ask your lender to show you both side by side.

### 2 · SHOP THE LENDER, NOT JUST THE HOUSE

Rates and fees on the same day, for the same buyer, can differ from one lender to the next. Get a Loan Estimate from two or three lenders on the same day so you're comparing the same market. Read page one for the rate and page two for the fees and points. A low rate with heavy points is a different loan than it looks.

### 3 · YOUR CREDIT AND DOWN PAYMENT MOVE THE RATE

Lenders price loans in tiers. A modest bump in your credit score, or a slightly larger down payment, can drop you into a better one. If you're a few months out, ask a lender exactly what would move you up a tier. Our lender partner also does credit repair, and this is precisely the kind of question to bring them.

### 4 · THE LOAN TYPE MATTERS

Conventional, FHA, and VA loans price differently and carry different costs. If you've served, ask about a VA loan before anything else. It's a benefit you earned, and it's worth having someone walk you through it properly.

### 5 · BUY THE PAYMENT, NOT THE FORECAST

If the payment works today, the house works today. If rates fall later, refinancing is a real option, though it has its own costs and no one can promise the timing. If the payment doesn't work today, the answer isn't to hope. It's a different price range, a different loan, or a few more months of preparation.

*Before you tour a house*

Get fully approved at today's rate, with a payment you're comfortable with in writing. Then tour. It's much easier to love the right house when you already know what it costs every month.

Rates, programs and loan limits change often. This is general information, not financial advice. Confirm every number with a licensed lender.

*Questions about a loan?*

**ASK US, OR ASK OUR LENDER**

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LET'S TALK IT THROUGH

START A CONVERSATION ›



HOME · THE HOLIDAYS

# READY FOR COMPANY

*A guest-ready house in one weekend, without a single trip to a furniture store.*

BY PETER ROYSTER

We walk through a lot of houses, and we can tell you exactly where a guest decides how your home feels. It's the first fifteen feet inside the front door, the guest bathroom, and wherever people end up standing with a plate. That last one is almost always the kitchen, no matter how nice the living room is.

None of this is decorating. It's the same short list we give sellers before photos, because a house that's ready for buyers is a house that's ready for your sister-in-law. Start on Saturday morning and you're done by Sunday supper.

### SATURDAY: THE WAY IN

Walk up to your own front door at dusk, the way your guests will. Is the house number readable from the street? Does the porch light work, and is it a warm bulb rather than the bluish one most fixtures ship with? Sweep the walk, wipe the door, and put one thing by it that says someone lives here: a planter, a wreath, a pair of pumpkins you haven't carved.

Inside, clear the entry completely. Shoes, mail, backpacks, the dog leash. Guests need somewhere to put a coat and a casserole dish in the first ten seconds, and a hallway table with nothing on it is the most welcoming furniture in the house.

*Hosting this year?*

THE SAME LIST WE GIVE OUR SELLERS

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### SATURDAY AFTERNOON: THE GUEST BATH

This is the one room every guest sees alone, with the door closed and nothing to do but look around. Clear the counter down to soap and a hand towel. Put out a fresh roll of paper where it can be found without opening a cabinet. Replace any burned-out bulb over the mirror, and if the caulk around the tub has gone gray, a new bead is an hour's work and makes the whole room look cleaner than any scrubbing will.

### SUNDAY MORNING: WHERE PEOPLE ACTUALLY STAND

Clear one full stretch of kitchen counter, at least three feet, and keep it clear until the meal. That's where the dishes people bring will land. Move the trash and recycling somewhere guests can find without asking. Check that the dishwasher is empty before anyone arrives, so the cleanup has somewhere to go.

Then count your seats. Most homes have fewer chairs than they think once the dining table fills up. Folding chairs from the garage are fine. Guests standing for an hour with a plate are not.

### SUNDAY AFTERNOON: THE LITTLE THINGS THAT MAKE IT EASY

Write the Wi-Fi name and password on a card and leave it on the counter. Light the rooms people will use with lamps rather than overheads. Run every faucet and flush every toilet once, so a slow drain announces itself on Sunday and not on Thursday at four o'clock.

## IF SOMEONE IS STAYING OVER

- **SLEEP IN THE GUEST BED ONE NIGHT**
  Ten minutes on it tells you everything: the lumpy pillow, the lamp that's out of reach, the blind that lets the streetlight in.
- **EMPTY ONE DRAWER AND HALF THE CLOSET**
  Plus a few hangers. It is the single most gracious thing you can do for a guest.

Nobody remembers whether the baseboards were dusted. Everybody remembers whether there was somewhere to sit.

*Need a hand before the 26th?*

**OUR OWN VENDOR LIST, FREELY GIVEN**

The plumbers, cleaners and handymen we call for our own houses. Just ask.

NO CHARGE, NO CATCH

ASK FOR A REFERRAL ›

BEFORE YOU LIST

# SELLING OVER THE HOLIDAYS

Most sellers wait for spring. That is exactly why some of them shouldn't.

BY PETER ROYSTER



Every year a lot of sellers take the sign down at Thanksgiving and plan to try again in March. We understand it. The house is full, the calendar is full, and nobody wants a showing during pie.

But think about who tours a house the second week of December. Not someone browsing. Someone with a job starting in January, a lease running out, a relocation with a date on it. Holiday buyers are fewer and far more serious.

And the sellers who stay on the market through the holidays are the ones those buyers find.

## WHEN TO WAIT

If the house needs real work before it can show well, use the holidays to do it and list in late winter, ready.

If your own next home isn't lined up yet, don't force it. A sale with nowhere to go is a harder holiday than a late listing.

## IF YOU LIST NOW

- **DECORATE LIGHTLY, AND AFTER THE PHOTOS**
  Shoot the house clean. Holiday photos date a listing the day after New Year's.
- **SET THE SHOWING RULES YOU CAN LIVE WITH**
  Block Thanksgiving Day and Christmas week if you like. A serious buyer will work around you.
- **PRICE FOR THE BUYER IN FRONT OF YOU**
  Not for the spring market you're hoping to beat. Holiday buyers have done their homework.
- **LIGHT IT FOR SHORT DAYS**
  It gets dark early. Every lamp on, every blind open, porch light on a timer.

> "Here is what I would do if this were my house: list it clean before Thanksgiving, and let the buyers who need to move find it."
>
> PETER

*Thinking about this winter?*

**WE'LL TELL YOU STRAIGHT: NOW, OR SPRING**

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START WITH A PLAN

PLAN YOUR SALE ›

AT THE TABLE

# PUMPKIN DUMP CAKE

Pumpkin pie on the bottom, buttery yellow cake on top, and about ten minutes of actual work. It is the dessert for the house that is already full of people.

SERVES 12 · 10 MINUTES OF WORK, ABOUT AN HOUR IN THE OVEN

### INGREDIENTS

2 cans (15 oz each) pure pumpkin
1½ cups half-and-half
1 cup brown sugar
3 large eggs
1½ tsp vanilla extract

1½ tsp nutmeg
1 tsp cinnamon
¾ tsp ground ginger

1 box yellow cake mix
1 cup unsalted butter, melted
(¼ cup in, ¾ cup on top)

### TO SERVE

Whipped cream and a little fresh nutmeg grated over the top. A scoop of vanilla ice cream if it is still warm, and in Houston in November it may well be.



### 1 · HEAT AND GREASE

Heat the oven to 350°F and grease a 13 by 9 inch metal pan. Metal browns the top better than glass, and the top is the best part.

### 2 · MAKE THE PUMPKIN LAYER

Whisk the half-and-half, brown sugar, eggs, spices and vanilla in a big bowl until smooth. Whisk in the pumpkin, then a quarter cup of the melted butter. Pour it into the pan and spread it to the corners.

### 3 · DUMP, AND THEN LEAVE IT ALONE

Sprinkle the dry cake mix evenly over the pumpkin. Drizzle the rest of the butter over the top and nudge it around with the back of a spoon so every patch of mix gets some. Do not stir. The layers are the whole point.

### 4 · BAKE

About an hour, until the top is deep golden and the middle no longer jiggles. Dry, powdery spots on top mean that patch missed the butter. A little more next time.

### 5 · LET IT SET

Cool it to room temperature so the pumpkin layer firms up enough to cut clean squares. It keeps covered in the refrigerator for a few days and is good cold, warm, or anywhere in between.

### USE PUMPKIN, NOT PIE FILLING

Canned pumpkin pie filling is already sweetened and spiced, so it throws the whole thing off. Look for cans that say pure pumpkin.

Adapted from a recipe by Micah A. Leal.

*Made it? Tell us.*

**SEND US A PHOTO**

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We'll run the best one next month.

MORE FROM OUR KITCHEN

SEE ALL RECIPES ›

HOME · SEASONAL

ONE BIG DAY.
NO SURPRISES.

# THE THANKSGIVING KITCHEN

The hardest-working day your kitchen has all year. Six things to check before Thursday the 26th, so the only thing that gets overcooked is the conversation.

### GREASE GOES IN A CAN

Not down the sink, and not down the disposal with hot water chasing it. It cools in the pipe and sets like candle wax. Pour it into an old can, let it harden, and throw it out.

### GO EASY ON THE DISPOSAL

Potato peels, celery, onion skins and turkey bones are the classic holiday clog. Scrape plates into the trash and save the disposal for scraps.

### FRY OUTSIDE, FAR OUTSIDE

A turkey fryer belongs on flat ground, well away from the house, the garage and anything with a roof. Never on a wood deck. And the bird goes in completely thawed and patted dry.

### TEST THE OVEN THIS WEEKEND

Run it at 350 for half an hour with an oven thermometer inside. If it's running hot or cold, better to learn on a sheet of cookies than on a twenty-pound bird.

### THE KITCHEN SMOKE DETECTOR

Press the test button. If you're tempted to pull the battery because it goes off every time you sear something, move the detector a little farther from the stove instead.

### KNOW WHERE THE EXTINGUISHER IS

Check that the gauge needle is in the green, and that it's somewhere you can reach without leaning over the stove. For a grease fire: lid on the pan, burner off, never water.

### THE FRIDAY-MORNING CALL

If a drain does back up, stop running water into it and don't pour chemical cleaner on top of a full sink of grease. It rarely works, and it makes the plumber's job harder.

Plumbers are busy the day after Thanksgiving. Save a good one's number in your phone now, before you need it. If you don't have one, ask us for ours.

*Need a name you can trust?*

**OUR OWN VENDOR LIST, FREELY GIVEN**

The plumbers and handymen we call for our own houses. Just ask.

NO CHARGE, NO CATCH

ASK FOR A REFERRAL ›

NEIGHBORHOOD SPOTLIGHT

# KINGWOOD
# THE LIVABLE FOREST

A master-planned community built around its trees rather than in spite of them, beside the San Jacinto River and Lake Houston.

BY VICKY ROYSTER

Drive into Kingwood for the first time and the thing you notice is what you can't see. Houses sit back behind pine and hardwood, the streets curve, and the trails disappear into green between the neighborhoods. That was the plan from the start.

Kingwood was a joint project of Friendswood Development Company, then an Exxon subsidiary, and King Ranch, built beginning in the 1970s on about 14,000 acres in far northeast Harris County, reaching into Montgomery County. The greenbelts were part of the original design, not something added later, and the community has gone by the same nickname ever since: the Livable Forest.

It grew as a collection of neighborhoods its residents call villages, each with its own character and era of homes, all stitched together by the trail system. In 1996, the City of Houston annexed Kingwood, which is why a community that feels like a small town has a Houston address.

### ABOUT THE WATER

Kingwood sits beside Lake Houston and the San Jacinto River, and that is part of its beauty and part of its history. In 2017, Hurricane Harvey brought severe flooding and evacuations to parts of the community. Since then the City of Houston has worked on improving the Lake Houston dam spillway, a project whose second phase includes eleven new gates on the dam's east side. If you're looking here, as anywhere near water, ask for the property's flood history and the seller's disclosure, and check the flood maps for the exact lot.

### KINGWOOD AT A GLANCE

**1970s**
Development begins, by Friendswood Development and King Ranch

**~14,000**
acres in northeast Harris County

**~75 miles**
of greenbelt trails, with five trail associations helping maintain them

**1996**
Annexed by the City of Houston

**1976**
Kingwood Service Association founded; it keeps up the three main entrances

*Walk one of the greenbelt trails on a cool November morning before you look at a single house. You'll understand the place faster.*

VICKY

Sources: Texas State Historical Association, Handbook of Texas; City of Houston, Super Neighborhood 43; Community Impact (Lake Houston, Humble & Kingwood). Trail mileage varies by source.

*Curious about Kingwood?*

ASK US ABOUT ANY NEIGHBORHOOD
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EXPLORE THE AREA
OUR NEIGHBORHOODS ›



LIFE TRANSITIONS

# THE FIRST HOLIDAYS APART

When a divorce and the holidays land in the same season, the house is usually in the middle of both. A calm word on what can wait and what can't.

BY VICKY ROYSTER

The holidays put a spotlight on the house. It's where the traditions happened, and it can feel as though deciding anything about it in December means deciding about everything. It doesn't. Most of the big decisions can wait until January. A few small ones can't.

## WHAT CAN WAIT

**Whether to sell.** Keeping the house, selling it, or one spouse buying the other out are all real options, and the right one depends on the decree and the numbers. Nobody should have to choose between them over a holiday weekend.

**Listing it.** If a sale is coming, a January listing prepared over the holidays is far better than a rushed one in December.

## WHAT CAN'T

**The mortgage payment.** Keep it current, whoever is living there. If you're both on the loan, a late payment hurts both credit reports, and both of you will need good credit for whatever comes next.

**A real value.** Not an online estimate. A real look at what the house would sell for now gives both attorneys the same starting number and takes one argument off the table.

**The paperwork.** Know where the deed, the mortgage statements and the insurance policy are, and make sure the homeowner's policy stays in force.

**The line we don't cross.** We're real estate agents, not attorneys. How the house is divided, who keeps it, and what the decree says are decisions for you and your attorney. What we do is give you clear, neutral numbers and handle the sale with discretion when it's time.

LIFE STAGES

# ONE MORE HOLIDAY HERE?

For a lot of empty nesters, Thanksgiving is when the question finally gets asked out loud. Here is how to answer it with clear eyes.

BY PETER ROYSTER

It usually happens around the second helping. The kids are home, every bedroom is full for exactly four nights, and somebody says it: do you two really need all this house anymore? Then everyone goes back to the pie, and nobody brings it up again until next year.

We'd like to suggest a better way to use the holiday. Don't decide anything at the table. Instead, treat this Thanksgiving as a test, and pay attention.

### COUNT THE ROOMS YOU ACTUALLY USED

Not the rooms that were full on Thursday. The rooms you used the other 361 days. If the answer is the kitchen, the den, and your bedroom, that's useful information. If you used every one of them, that's useful too.

### ASK WHAT THE HOUSE COST YOU THIS YEAR

Taxes, insurance, the roof, the yard you now pay someone else to mow, the pool nobody swims in. Add it up once. The number is often bigger than people expect, and it's the real price of keeping the big house for the holidays.

### ASK THE KIDS WHERE THEY'D COME HOME TO

Most families say the same thing when someone finally asks. It's you they come home to, not the address. A guest room and a big table in a smaller house can hold the holiday just fine.

### AND IF THE ANSWER IS STAY

Then stay, and enjoy it without the question hanging over the table. Not every empty nester should sell. Some homes fit for twenty more years. The point isn't to move. It's to choose on purpose.

It's you they come home to, not the address.

*Thinking about it?*

WE'LL RUN THE NUMBERS BOTH WAYS

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JUST THE NUMBERS

WHAT'S MY HOME WORTH ›

A MOVE LIVE LOVE TX TEAM™ TRADITION

# THE GREAT PUMPKIN CONTEST WINNERS

Three age groups, a stack of very serious pumpkins, and one hard decision per group. Here are this season's champions.

### AGES 4–6

[DATA NEEDED: artwork]

[DATA NEEDED: first-place name]

PUMPKIN PATCH PALS

### AGES 7–9

[DATA NEEDED: artwork]

[DATA NEEDED: first-place name]

TRICK-OR-TREAT CREW

### AGES 10–12

[DATA NEEDED: artwork]

[DATA NEEDED: first-place name]

HAUNTED HOUSE ARTISTS

Thank you to every family who sent in a page. Second and third place in each group: [DATA NEEDED: names by group]. Every entry was judged without names, so it stayed about the art.

Our thanks again to Matt Brown of Encompass Lending Group for helping sponsor this season's prizes. First place in each group takes home a $25 Target gift card, a themed craft kit and a Coloring Champion Certificate.

*Next season*

[DATA NEEDED: is there a winter contest? If yes, its name and dates. If not, this box says "The Little Artists Club is back in the new year. Watch this space."]

*Dream. Create. Be you.*

**FREE TO ENTER, NO PURCHASE NECESSARY**

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FOR YOUNG ARTISTS

LITTLE ARTISTS CLUB ›

# FIVE THINGS WORTH DOING

*November, from the bay to the pines.*

The lights go up, the parade comes back, and the mornings finally feel like fall. Here's what we'd actually leave the house for this month.



### SALUTE TO MILITARY SERVICE & FIRST RESPONDERS

The Kemah Boardwalk spends a weekend thanking the people who serve. Bring the family down to the water and say it in person too.

NOV 7–8 · KEMAH BOARDWALK

### LIGHTING OF THE DOVES

The Woodlands kicks off its holiday season at Town Green Park, with live music, ice carvers, Santa's arrival and fireworks over the Waterway.

SAT NOV 21 · 3–8PM · THE WOODLANDS

### HOLIDAY IN THE GARDENS

Moody Gardens lights up its seaside trail for the season, with an ice attraction and a holiday show. Value nights run Sunday through Thursday, November 30 to December 17.

NOV 21 – JAN 2 · NIGHTLY 6–10PM · GALVESTON

### H-E-B THANKSGIVING DAY PARADE

The 77th parade fills downtown with balloons, floats and marching bands. Get there early with a thermos and a folding chair.

THU NOV 26 · 9AM · DOWNTOWN HOUSTON

### A MORNING ON THE KINGWOOD TRAILS

No ticket required. Walk a stretch of the greenbelt from page 13 on the first cool morning of the month, and get home before the turkey needs you.

ALL MONTH · KINGWOOD

### MARK YOUR CALENDAR

- Kemah Salute · Nov 7–8
- Veterans Day · Nov 11
- Lighting of the Doves · Nov 21
- Moody Gardens lights · Nov 21
- Thanksgiving Parade · Nov 26
- Ren Fest final day · Nov 29

Dates and times confirmed on each organizer's own website in October 2026. Plans change, so check before you go.

> November is the month Houston finally gets to wear a jacket, and we all wear it a little too proudly.
>
> — *Vicky*

*We live here.*
*We love it here.*

**MORE LOCAL, EVERY WEEK**

Texas Roots Weekly lands each Friday with the weekend's best.

# HOMES WE'RE SHOWCASING

*Five doors worth opening this month.*

GALVESTON TO CONROE.



FEATURED · HUMBLE

## 12542 Sabine Point Dr

HUMBLE, TX · BALMORAL, GATED SECTION

**$315,000**

A 2019 one-story with 3 bedrooms and 2 baths, and a fully paid-off Tesla solar system with two paid-off Powerwalls. Real energy savings, not a lease to take over. Minutes from Kingwood.

SEE THIS HOME ›

## ALSO ON THE MARKET

**18926 WILDROSE LN** — $975,000
Tomball · Acreage and room to spread out, north of the Grand Parkway.
VIEW ›

**2103 CARRIAGE RUN W** — $485,000
Conroe · A well-kept home on a quiet run, minutes from the lake.
VIEW ›

**7000 SEAWALL BLVD #324** — $230,000
Galveston · A Gulf-front condo on the seawall, with the beach right across the street.
VIEW ›

**183 COUNTY ROAD 436** — $155,000
Dayton · Land with electric, a water well and septic already in. Build the thing you've been sketching.
VIEW ›

List prices current as of October 26, 2026 and subject to change. Each home links to its full page at movelivelovetx.com.

**BUYING THIS WINTER?**

With 5.5 months of inventory and homes averaging 58 days on the market, you have time to think and room to negotiate. Run the payment first.

*Your next home starts here.*

**PETER & VICKY ROYSTER**
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CB&A, Realtors · The Woodlands, TX

YOU ASKED

# ASK PETER & VICKY

Four questions we hear all the time this time of year, answered the way we'd answer them at your kitchen table.

### "SHOULD WE WAIT UNTIL AFTER THE HOLIDAYS TO BUY?"

Only if the holidays are the reason you can't focus. If you're ready and approved, December is a good month to shop. Fewer buyers are out, sellers who are still listed usually mean it, and you'll get more of an agent's attention than you will in April.

### "IS A HOME WARRANTY WORTH IT?"

Sometimes. It can make sense on a house with older appliances and systems, especially in the first year. Read what it excludes before you count on it, and know it isn't a substitute for an inspection. When a seller offers one, it's a nice extra, not a reason to skip asking about the roof.




### "WHAT EXACTLY IS THE OPTION PERIOD?"

It's the stretch of days, written into a Texas contract, when a buyer can walk away for any reason. You pay a small option fee for that right, which you don't get back, and if you terminate in time your earnest money is generally returned. It's when inspections and repair negotiations happen. Shortening it to win a bidding war made sense in 2021. In a market with 58 days on market, keep it long enough to do it properly.

### "WE JUST BOUGHT. DO WE NEED TO DO ANYTHING ABOUT OUR PROPERTY TAXES?"

Yes, and it's easy to miss. If it's your primary home, apply for the homestead exemption with your county's appraisal district once you've moved in. It isn't automatic, and it lowers your taxable value. Each district's website has the form and the rules. And when your new appraisal notice comes in the spring, read it. You can protest a value you think is wrong.

*Got a question?*

Send it to **homes@movelivelovetx.com** and we'll answer it here next month, with first names only or anonymously if you'd rather. No question about your own house is too small, and we have genuinely never minded being asked.

*Real questions. Real answers.*

PETER & VICKY ROYSTER · CB&A, REALTORS
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ASK US ANYTHING

SEND A QUESTION ›



UNTIL NEXT MONTH

# Let's Write Your Story

*Whether you're moving this spring, three years from now, or simply like knowing what your house is worth, we're here, anywhere from Galveston to Conroe, and there's never a bill for a conversation.*

| 28+ | 4.9 | 2004 |
| --- | --- | --- |
| YEARS COMBINED | GOOGLE RATING | HELPING HOUSTON SINCE |

START A CONVERSATION ›


**PETER & VICKY ROYSTER**

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100% DIGITAL — NO PAPER, NO PRINTING, NO WASTE.